

Activist OpSec Checklist

74-point operational security checklist for organizers, advocates, and protesters.

NOTE: Operational security is professionalism, not paranoia. Protecting your data protects your community. Review quarterly.

Device Security

☐ Full-disk encryption enabled on all devices	☐ Strong passcode (6+ digits, not biometric alone)
☐ Auto-lock set to 1–2 minutes	☐ OS and apps fully updated
☐ Antivirus installed (Android)	☐ Unused apps removed
☐ Location services minimized	☐ App permissions reviewed quarterly
☐ Backups encrypted	☐ Cloud sync disabled for sensitive files

Communication Security

☐ Signal installed for internal comms	☐ Signal disappearing messages enabled (7 days)
☐ ProtonMail or Tutanota for sensitive email	☐ Avoid SMS/standard calls for sensitive topics
☐ Signal group has 2+ trusted admins	☐ New members vetted before adding to secure groups
☐ Separate email for organizing vs personal	☐ Password manager in use (Bitwarden recommended)
☐ Unique passwords on all accounts	☐ 2FA enabled everywhere (authenticator app, not SMS)

Protest Safety

☐ KYR reviewed before attending	☐ Emergency contact written on arm in marker
☐ Legal observer contact saved (not just in phone)	☐ Bail fund contact saved
☐ Buddy system established	☐ Check-in protocol agreed
☐ Avoid identifiable clothing/tattoos	☐ Face covering available if desired
☐ Disable Face ID/Touch ID before attending	☐ Airplane mode + VPN before filming police
☐ Back up footage immediately after	☐ Know first aid basics

Social Media & Digital Footprint

☐ Review public posts quarterly	☐ Audit tagged photos and location data
☐ Private accounts for sensitive organizing	☐ Avoid real-time location posts during actions
☐ Do not post others faces without consent	☐ Review past event RSVPs (they are public)

☐ Use VPN on public WiFi always	☐ Tor Browser for sensitive research
☐ Check HaveIBeenPwned.com for breaches	☐ Separate browser profiles for organizing vs personal

Document & Organizational Security

☐ Sensitive files encrypted (VeraCrypt/Cryptomator)	☐ Member lists not stored unencrypted in cloud
☐ Minimal data retention policy followed	☐ Old sensitive files securely deleted
☐ Shared doc access reviewed monthly	☐ Removed members lose access immediately
☐ Leadership team uses Signal for internal comms	☐ New member vetting process documented
☐ Suspicious contact reporting protocol exists	☐ Data breach response plan exists
<i>TIP: Build a quarterly security review into your organizational calendar. The threat level changes — your practices should too.</i>	